21st August, 2025

PayInvert Service Level Agreement

Introduction

This Service Level Agreement (SLA) outlines the service level commitments and performance targets for **PayInvert's Merchant Services**, as provided under the Merchant Service Agreement (MSA). It defines PayInvert's objectives for service availability, performance, support responsiveness, incident management, reporting, and related processes. This SLA is for reference and transparency of service standards; it does **not** provide for service credits, financial penalties, or other remedies in the event of any service level breach, as detailed in the SLA Limitations section below. PayInvert will, however, use best efforts to ensure the services operate optimally and in line with generally accepted industry standards.

Scope of Services Covered

This SLA applies to **all services offered under the PayInvert MSA**, including but not limited to:

- **Card Payment Processing (Local and International)** – Authorization and processing of card transactions for both local and international card schemes.
- **USSD Payments** – Payments initiated via USSD channels.
- **Bank Transfers** – Processing of direct bank transfer payment methods.
- **API Integrations** – PayInvert's payment gateway APIs used by merchants for transaction processing and integrations.
- **Merchant Dashboard** – The online portal for merchants to monitor transactions, manage their account, and access reports.
- **Settlement Processing** – The transfer of funds to merchant bank accounts for completed transactions, including daily settlement for local payments and appropriate processing for international transactions.

All the above services are collectively referred to as "the Services" in this SLA. The targets and processes defined here apply across these Services unless otherwise noted.

Service Availability (Uptime)

PayInvert is committed to high availability of its Services. Our service uptime is defined as the percentage of time the core Services are operational, accessible, and functioning without critical issues, excluding scheduled maintenance windows and events outside PayInvert's control (e.g., force majeure, internet backbone failures, upstream banking network outages).

- **Uptime Guarantee:** PayInvert targets at least **99.9% uptime** for its core transaction processing Services on a 24/7/365 basis. This equates to a maximum of roughly **43 minutes of unplanned downtime per month** (approximately 8.7 hours per year). This high availability target is in line with industry standards for mission-critical payment systems like ours and reflects PayInvert's best efforts under the MSA.
- **Measurement Period:** Uptime is measured monthly (each calendar month) as: Availability % = (Total Minutes in Month - Unplanned Downtime Minutes) / Total Minutes in Month × 100. Please note, scheduled maintenance downtime (with prior notice) and any downtime caused by factors outside PayInvert's control are excluded from this calculation.
- **Scheduled Maintenance:** PayInvert will perform necessary maintenance during off-peak periods to minimize impact. Merchants will be provided at least 3-5 business days' advance notice of any scheduled maintenance that may cause service interruption. Scheduled maintenance windows will be planned to be of limited duration (typically not exceeding 60 minutes per maintenance event, and no more than 24 hours total per month). During these periods, affected services may be unavailable or slower, but such downtime is **pre-planned and excluded** from uptime calculations.
- **Unplanned Outages:** In the event of an unplanned service disruption, PayInvert will work to restore service as quickly as possible (see **Incident Management** below for response procedures). Downtime for us, begins when the service becomes unavailable to merchants and ends when service is fully restored. Be aware that, PayInvert strives hard to meet the above availability target, the MSA stipulates that **uninterrupted or error-free service cannot be guaranteed**, but PayInvert will use her best efforts to ensure an optimal performance at all times.

Performance and Response Time Commitments

PayInvert's Services are engineered for fast and reliable performance. This section defines key performance targets:

- **API Response Times:** The PayInvert payment API and related endpoints are designed to respond quickly to transaction requests. Industry benchmarks for mission-critical payment APIs range around 300–500 milliseconds for processing responses. PayInvert's target is to have most API calls (e.g., authorization requests) complete within this range under normal conditions. Specifically, the goal is that **~95% of API requests are responded to within 500ms, and 99% within 1 second**, under steady state load. In no event should any valid payment request timeout without a response unless external dependencies (e.g., issuer bank networks) are causing delays.
- **Transaction Processing Throughput:** The platform can handle high transaction volumes typical of peak periods (such as sales promotions). PayInvert will continuously monitor and scale the system to accommodate expected workloads. There are no fixed transaction-per-second guarantees in this SLA, but the system is built to process transactions concurrently with low latency. If a merchant expects an unusually large spike in volume, PayInvert's support should be notified to ensure capacity planning.
- **Merchant Dashboard Performance:** The merchant dashboard and reporting interfaces should load and display data within reasonable timeframes. Page loads and data queries are expected to execute within a few seconds under normal use. Data-intensive queries (e.g. large date range reports) may take longer, but the system is optimized for typical usage.
- **Settlement Processing Timelines:** PayInvert will initiate settlement of collected funds to the merchant's designated bank account on a timely basis. For local currency card transactions and bank transfers, settlements are typically processed on a **next-business-day (T+1)** schedule (subject to banking hours and cut-off times). International card transactions or multi-currency settlements may have longer funding timelines (e.g. T+2 or T+3 days) as per card scheme and acquiring bank processes; any such differences will be communicated to the merchant in advance. The SLA target is that **99% of due settlements are processed on schedule** (next day for local, or within the communicated timeline for international). Delays caused by third-party banking networks or compliance checks are outside PayInvert's control, but PayInvert will work to minimize any such delays.

- **Data Integrity and Accuracy:** All transaction data and records will be processed accurately and reflected correctly in the system. **Data integrity** is paramount – PayInvert employs safeguards (redundant databases, integrity checks, backups) to ensure that transactions are neither lost nor duplicated in the system. In practice, this means a confirmed transaction will either be fully completed and recorded, or not processed at all – no partial or missing data. The target is **100% accuracy** of transaction records and **zero data loss** for completed transactions. In the unlikely event of any data inconsistency or corruption, PayInvert will restore from secure backups and logs to reconcile all transaction data. Recovery Point Objective (RPO) for transactional data is near zero (to preserve all committed transactions), and Recovery Time Objective (RTO) for restoration of data integrity is as short as possible (typically within a few hours for any major data store failure).

These performance targets are based on industry standards and best practices, ensuring that PayInvert's services operate with the speed and reliability that merchants expect. They are not hard guarantees (no financial remedies for missing targets), but PayInvert will monitor performance continuously and allocate resources to meet these objectives. Performance metrics and incidents may be reviewed periodically with merchants upon request.

Customer Support and Response Times

PayInvert provides responsive merchant support to address service issues or inquiries. Merchants can reach PayInvert's support 24/7 via our designated support email or ticketing system (as provided in the MSA). The following are the **severity levels** for incidents and the **targeted response and resolution times** for each:

- **Severity 1 – Critical Impact:** Critical issues are those causing a **complete outage** or severe disruption of all payment services – for example, the inability to process any transactions, system-wide failure, or major security breach. No workaround is available.
    - **Examples of these:** Payment gateway down for all users; whereby all card payments are failing; or the merchant dashboard is completely inaccessible for all merchants.
    - **Initial Response Time:** Within 30 minutes (acknowledgment of the issue reported or detected, with immediate technical resources engaged) – available 24x7. PayInvert will begin addressing a Sev-1 incident **immediately** upon awareness, at any hour.

- **Resolution Target: 4 hours or less** to restore service or provide a viable workaround. PayInvert will commit full resources (engineering and management) around the clock until the issue is resolved. Regular updates will be provided to the merchant (e.g., hourly status updates or as agreed). Escalation to senior management is immediate on a Sev-1 incident.

- **Severity 2 – High Impact:** High severity issues significantly impair service operation for the merchant, but some functionality may still be working. The problem is urgent but possibly **partial in scope**, or a temporary workaround exists to mitigate full impact.
  - **Examples:** Transactions are processing slowly or intermittently failing; a specific payment method (e.g., only USSD or only international cards) is down while others work; the merchant dashboard or API system is experiencing serious performance degradation.
  - **Initial Response Time:** Within 1 hour (24x7). PayInvert support will acknowledge and start investigating within one hour of a high impact issue report. Outside business hours, on-call staff will be engaged.
  - **Resolution Target:** 12 hours or next business day for full resolution or an effective workaround. Continuous effort will be applied during business hours until resolved, and if the issue persists into off-hours, it will be worked on with urgency the following day (unless it threatens to escalate towards Critical). High severity issues are escalated to technical leads if not resolved within the initial target period.
- **Severity 3 – Medium Impact:** Medium issues involve moderate impact on the services or minor features not working as expected. Core transaction processing is mostly unaffected, and there may be an acceptable workaround. These issues, while important, do not halt the merchant's primary operations.
  - **Examples:** A non-critical feature on the dashboard (e.g. reporting filter or a minor UI bug) is not working correctly; a single transaction failed due to a suspected platform bug but others are processing; minor delays in settlement reporting that do not affect fund movement.
  - **Initial Response Time:** Within 4 business hours. (During normal support hours, typically 8am–6pm local time, Monday–Friday. If a medium issue is reported outside business hours, it will be addressed the next business day.)

    - **Resolution Target:** 2-3 business days for resolution or inclusion in a planned software update. Many medium issues may be resolved with a configuration change or minor fix more quickly, but more complex bugs will be scheduled for patching in an upcoming release. PayInvert will keep the merchant informed of progress and the expected fix timeline.

- **Severity 4 – Low Impact:** Low priority issues, general questions, or cosmetic errors that have little to no impact on normal operations. These include informational inquiries, documentation requests, or feature suggestions.
    - **Examples:** A typo in the dashboard interface; how-to questions about using an API; a request for enhancement or new report format; any incident that does **not** materially affect transaction processing or business operations.
    - **Initial Response Time:** Within 1 business day (during business hours).
    - **Resolution Target:** 5-10 business days or in the next scheduled software release or report cycle, as applicable. Low-impact items may be queued behind higher-severity fixes. If the low-severity issue is a request, it may be closed once guidance is provided or logged for future enhancement.

Definition of Response and Resolution: "Response" means a support engineer has reviewed the incident ticket and responded to the merchant acknowledging the issue and typically providing an initial assessment or asking for additional information. "Resolution" means the underlying problem has been fixed or a reasonable workaround provided to restore normal operation to the merchant's satisfaction. In the case of Severity 1 incidents, resolution may involve a restoration of service (even if a full root-cause fix comes later). All times are **targets**, not guarantees, but PayInvert's support team will make commercially reasonable efforts to meet or beat these timelines, consistent with industry best practices for payment service providers.

Incident Management and Escalation

PayInvert maintains a robust **incident management process** to quickly address and resolve service interruptions or degradations. This process includes incident classification, merchant notifications, internal escalation procedures, and post-incident recovery steps:

- **Incident Classification:** When an incident is detected (via monitoring alerts or merchant report), it is immediately classified by severity. The criteria in the Support section above (Severity 1–4) are used to determine the level. This classification drives the urgency and actions required. For example, a complete service outage is classified as Severity 1 (Critical) and triggers an emergency response, while a partial degradation might be Severity 2 (High), etc.. The classification may be adjusted in real-time if the impact is found to be more or less severe than initially thought.
- **Notification and Communication:** PayInvert will notify affected merchants about major incidents proactively.
    - For **Critical (Sev-1)** incidents affecting multiple merchants or a whole service, PayInvert will send out an incident alert via email and/or in-dashboard notification **within 60 minutes** of incident identification, to inform merchants of the problem and acknowledge that it is being addressed. More urgent or widespread issues may see communications even sooner (e.g. an immediate banner on the dashboard or SMS, if applicable). Regular updates will be provided (for example, hourly or any time there is a significant development). Once resolved, a resolution notice will be sent with a brief summary of the issue.
    - Typically, for **High (Sev-2)** incidents that are significant but possibly not noticed by all merchants (e.g. an issue with a specific payment method), PayInvert will notify the impacted merchants or post a status update on the PayInvert status page. Notification target is generally **within a couple of hours** of confirming the issue, or sooner if merchant impact is growing. Updates will be periodic until resolution.
    - For typical **Medium/Low** incidents (Sev-3 or 4), immediate broad communication is typically not necessary unless merchants are likely to notice issues. In those cases, updates might be limited to the merchants who reported the issue or to a maintenance bulletin if it will be fixed in an upcoming release. Merchants can always inquire for status via support tickets.
    - **Status Page:** PayInvert will maintain an online Status Page where the current system status and incident updates are posted in real time. Merchants are hereby encouraged to subscribe to status notifications, to receive instant updates on any widespread outages.

- **Internal Escalation:** PayInvert has an internal escalation path to ensure the right resources address incidents promptly:
    - Severity 1 incidents invoke an all-hands-on-deck approach: engineers, operations, and management are immediately engaged. The incident is managed by a lead who coordinates technical resolution and a communication officer who handles merchant updates (for a major outage, this will involve the TPM and/or senior leadership). If any third-party providers (e.g., banking partners, telecom for USSD) are involved in the cause, PayInvert will escalate the issue with those providers with the same urgency.
    - Severity 2 incidents are escalated to the on-call engineering team and relevant department leads within the hour. If not resolved within the target time, they are further escalated.
    - Severity 3 and 4 issues are handled by the support and engineering teams in due course, but if a Medium issue remains unresolved and significantly impacts a merchant's operations beyond the expected timeline, merchants can request escalation through their account manager or by indicating the increased impact to support. PayInvert will then consider raising the priority of that issue.
    - In all cases, an escalation is designed to bring more expertise and resources to bear on the problem if initial responders cannot resolve it quickly.
- **Recovery and Remediation:** PayInvert's systems are built with redundancy and failover mechanisms to facilitate quick recovery. In a serious outage, failover to backup systems may be initiated to restore service while the primary issue is fixed, whenever possible. The expected **Recovery Time Objective (RTO)** for critical outages is to restore basic functionality within a few hours (as per the Severity 1 resolution target). After service restoration, permanent fixes or patches will be applied to prevent recurrence.
    - **Data Recovery:** If an incident involves data inconsistency or loss (e.g., due to hardware failure or bug), PayInvert will recover data from backups/logs as needed to ensure all transaction records are correct (see **Data Integrity** above). The goal is that no completed transaction data will be lost even in a severe incident, and any in-flight transactions

during an outage will be reconciled (either completed or rolled back) once systems are restored.

- **Post-Incident Review:** For any Critical incident (and certain High incidents), PayInvert will conduct a post-incident analysis internally. Upon merchant request, PayInvert can provide a **Root Cause Analysis (RCA) report** within a reasonable time (typically within 5-10 business days after resolution of a Sev-1 event). The RCA will outline the issue's cause, actions taken to fix it, and preventive measures for the future. This transparency helps maintain trust and continuous improvement.

Overall, our incident management workflow is designed to **minimize downtime and impact**, keep merchants informed, and continuously improve the reliability of PayInvert's services. PayInvert's approach aligns with the overall industry practices for managing similar high-availability systems (e.g., rapid 24/7 response for critical incidents and timely communications).

Transaction Reporting and Data Delivery

We totally understand that an accurate and timely reporting is an important service component for merchants. PayInvert will provide **periodic transaction reports** and data access as follows:

- **Daily Transaction & Settlement Reports:** PayInvert generates daily reports detailing the previous day's transactions and settlements. These reports include information such as transaction IDs, timestamps, payment methods, amounts, transaction status, and the settlement amount transferred to the merchant's bank account. **Availability:** Daily reports are typically available by the next business day (e.g., each morning) via the merchant dashboard or sent by email (as per the merchant's preference). This allows merchants to reconcile payments and settlements on a daily basis.
- **Merchant Dashboard (Real-Time Reporting):** The online dashboard provides on-demand access to transaction data. Merchants can simply log in at any time to view real-time or near-real-time information on transactions processed, approvals/declines, pending settlements, etc. The dashboard also offers filters and export functions so merchants can self-serve many of their reporting needs on an ad-hoc basis. Data on the dashboard is updated in real time as transactions occur (with minimal delay), ensuring transparency into current processing activity.

- **Monthly Statements:** On a monthly basis, PayInvert can provide summary statements or reports aggregating the transaction activity and fees for the month. These statements may include total volume, total settled amounts, fees deducted, chargebacks or refunds processed, and other summary metrics. Monthly reports are typically made available within the first week of the following month. They serve for merchant's record-keeping and financial reconciliation.
- **On-Demand Reports:** Merchants may request custom or ad-hoc reports (for example, a report of all transactions in a specific date range, or specific data fields not in standard reports). PayInvert will make reasonable efforts to accommodate such requests through the dashboard's reporting tools or by providing data extracts. In some cases, additional time may be needed for custom queries; the support team will advise on the timeline upon request (usually delivered within a few business days if not readily available on the dashboard).
- **Reporting Accuracy:** The data in all reports will match the transactions processed and the funds settled. Any unforeseen discrepancies identified by the merchant will be investigated and corrected as a priority. Since data integrity is assured as per this SLA, transaction records in reports will be complete and accurate.
- **Compliance and Regulatory Reports:** Where required (e.g., monthly/annual statements for regulatory compliance or audit logs), PayInvert will provide necessary documentation to the merchant. For instance, PCI-DSS related attestations for services, or records of transaction data retention policies, can be provided. These are usually handled outside of the daily/monthly reporting cadence and can be requested via our support page.

All reports are provided in a secure manner, either accessible only to authenticated merchant users on the dashboard or sent via encrypted channels/email as applicable. The expectation is that merchants will have timely information to manage their business and reconcile their accounts, without needing to chase PayInvert for data. If at any time a report is delayed or unavailable, merchants can contact support to obtain the data manually as a stop-gap.

SLA Limitations and Exclusions

While this SLA sets forth the targeted service levels, it is important for us to clarify the **limitations and exclusions** associated with these commitments:

- **No Service Credits or Penalties:** This SLA does **not** entitle the merchant to any service credits, financial penalties, or other compensation in the event that PayInvert fails to meet the stated targets. **No service credits, or remedies will apply for any breach of the SLA.** The service level targets described are simply goals that reflect optimal performance under normal circumstances, not contractual guarantees.

  The Merchant Service Agreement's limitation of liability and warranty disclaimers, apply fully to this SLA. PayInvert's sole obligation is to use commercially reasonable and good faith efforts to meet the service levels, and to rectify issues as described, without additional liability for not hitting a target in a given period.

- **Third-Party Dependencies:** Any downtime or certain performance issues attributable to external factors outside PayInvert's control are excluded from SLA calculations and commitments. This includes, for example, outages on the part of telecommunications providers, internet backbone issues, third-party payment schemes or banking networks being down, force majeure events (natural disasters, etc.), or the merchant's own systems (e.g., if the merchant's server or network is offline and cannot connect to PayInvert). PayInvert will make efforts to work with third-party providers to resolve issues, but cannot be held responsible for their failures.

- **Scheduled Maintenance Exclusion:** As noted under Service Availability, scheduled maintenance periods notified in advance are not counted as downtime and do not constitute an SLA breach. PayInvert will strive to keep maintenance brief and infrequent, and schedule it in low-traffic times, but such maintenance is necessary for security and performance updates.

- **Beta Services or Features:** If PayInvert offers any beta (pre-release) features or services to the merchant, those may not be covered by this SLA or may have lesser availability commitments.

  Such cases will be clearly communicated. The core services as listed in scope are fully covered by this SLA.

- **Merchant Responsibilities:** The merchant is expected to use the Services in accordance with the MSA and any integration guidelines. Any breach of security or misuse on the merchant's side (e.g., not safeguarding API keys or failing to maintain their own systems) that causes an incident is outside the scope of PayInvert's SLA obligations. For instance, if a merchant's integration is incorrectly implemented causing transaction failures, that would not count as PayInvert failing to meet SLA performance. Merchants should also maintain any required first-line support for their end-users if applicable, and then escalate issues to PayInvert as needed. Cooperation in troubleshooting (providing logs, details) will help meet resolution timelines.
- **Changes to SLA:** This SLA document may be updated by PayInvert from time to time (for example, to reflect improvements in service or changes in policies). Material changes will be communicated or notified to merchants as an update to the MSA or via official communication channels. However, any changes will not retroactively reduce service level commitments for any ongoing month without notice.

Please note, by using PayInvert's services, the merchant acknowledges and accepts that this SLA is provided as a good-faith outline of service objectives and procedures, and that the remedies for any service issues are limited to those expressly provided in the MSA (primarily, diligent corrective action by PayInvert) rather than monetary compensation.

This Service Level Agreement provides a very comprehensive overview of the performance and support standards you can expect from PayInvert's Merchant Services. PayInvert's goal is to be a reliable partner for your payment processing needs, delivering high uptime, fast performance, data accuracy, and responsive support. While no financial remedies are attached to these service levels, PayInvert stands by its commitments through continuous improvement and transparency. For any questions regarding this SLA or any aspect of the service, merchants may contact PayInvert for clarification.

This SLA is effective as of the date of the most recent update and applies to the merchant effective from date of acceptance and final onboarding on the PayInvert merchant dashboard. This is also subject to the terms and conditions therein and remains in force for the duration of the merchant's use of PayInvert's services.